Collaboration and Communication

Welcoming Your Teacher Candidate

- Arrange to meet with your teacher candidate before the official start of the experience. Spend time learning about one other as people, not just as educators.
- Introduce the teacher candidate to other faculty members, support personnel and administrators.
- Tour the school...staff work areas, the lounge, adult restrooms, etc.
- Post the teacher candidate's name *(Mr./Ms. Smith)* along with your name near the classroom door.
- Send a note to families to let them know you will have a teacher candidate co-teaching with you.
- Provide a desk *(preferably not a student-size desk)* or designate a work area for the teacher candidate with supplies and copies of necessary manuals, textbooks, the current read-aloud book, etc.
- Provide a picture of the class or individual students to help the teacher candidate learn names more quickly.
- Review items in the faculty handbook that directly affect the teacher candidate: the contractual day, issues related to school security, etc.
- Share that "bit of information" that matters: *"There is a 'Peanut Free' table in the cafeteria"* or "*Staff members never park in Lot A."*
- Explain any staff activities or special events the teacher candidate could choose to participate in or attend.
- Discuss classroom rules and expectations for student behavior as well as acceptable rewards and consequences. Review the student handbook.
- Assemble a binder with useful information including class lists, daily schedules, classroom rules, discipline referral forms, etc.
- On a desktop calendar or planner, mark important dates for faculty meetings, your week for hall duty, school-wide music programs, etc.
- Start a file with your favorite tried-and-true activities and good teaching ideas. Encourage your candidate to add to it throughout the experience.
- Leave an inspirational quote or article related to teaching on the candidate's desk that might spark an interesting discussion.
- Gestures of kindness, no matter how small, have a positive impact.
- If your teacher candidate will start later in the school year, send an email or letter from the class a few weeks before to share information about current units, upcoming special events, etc.

Copyright 2011, St. Cloud State University Teacher Quality Enhancement Grant. Used with Permission by the University of Minnesota-TC, Teacher Education Redesign Initiative (TERI)